

# GROUP WORK: NSTP (CWTS 1) FILIPINO TRAITS: ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

## ADVANTAGES

**Hospitality**- Filipinos are known for being hospitable, especially to tourists and wanderers who do not have a place to stay. For example every barrio fiesta, even though they do not know the people who come to their houses, they still give them a warm welcome and offer them food even if it is a beggar.

**Respect for the elderly**- Respect is deeply ingrained within the Filipino culture and language with terms like “po” and “opo” in their sentences when talking to elders or someone higher in position. While *opo* is a formal way of saying yes or agreement, they use *po* as a sentence extension for formality and respect. To be followed by “pagmamano”.

**Hardworking**- Filipino talents are sure to go above and beyond to fulfill their responsibilities. Deeply rooted in the culture of having strong family ties, Filipinos work hard to support their loved ones financially, so they can have a more comfortable life.

**Resourcefulness**- Filipinos are very resourceful, especially in tough situations. Whenever they encounter issues in their work, they always find a way to resolve and work around the problems and come up with better solutions. They rarely take a no as an answer and will, most of the time, have backup plans in case something comes up; hence the famous phrase, “*madiskarteng pinoy*” (*resourceful Filipino*).

**Family Oriented**- Filipinos are known for their strong family-oriented values, which represent a pillar of strength and support. Celebrations, decisions, and daily activities often revolve around family, emphasizing a collective approach to well-being and success. From extended families living together to supporting each other through thick and thin, family is a source of strength and comfort for Filipino people.

**Religiousness**- Spirituality is deeply embedded in Filipino culture. Although the country is predominantly Roman Catholic, it embraces other Christian denominations, Islam, and indigenous spiritual practices. Towns celebrate fiestas to honor their patron saints, reflecting the community’s devotion. Additionally, numerous national holidays are dedicated to religious observances, highlighting the importance of faith in shaping Filipino values and principles.

**Compassion**-Filipino people are renowned for their deep compassion; known locally as “malasakit,” this value inspires empathy and a proactive willingness to support those in need through either simple acts of kindness or extensive support in times of crisis. It reflects a commitment to prioritizing others and practicing selflessness.

**Humor and positivity**- in the face of difficult or challenging situations, members of the community are encouraged to look at the brighter side of things. The inclination for finding the good in the bad can be traced to the country’s location, which lies in the path of typhoons and sits along the Pacific Ring of Fire. In a place where natural calamities are commonplace, humor and positivity work as a coping mechanism, much like how some children laugh to hide their embarrassment after slipping or falling.

**Generosity**- Filipinos are naturally helpful and generous people. They give as much as they can and extend help to family members and even strangers when needed. This is seen through the abundance of charity drives and foundations in the country, especially when calamities arise.

## Disadvantages

**Crab Mentality** - Is a term used to explain a behavior located in some Filipino groups, wherein people may additionally prevent others' achievement out of jealousy or insecurity. The analogy comes from crabs in a bucket; while one crab tries to get away, the others will pull it back down instead of helping it climb out. This trait can occur in numerous social contexts, which include discouraging a person from pursuing their dreams or criticizing achievements. It's frequently rooted in a choice to keep organization norms or save you emotions of inferiority. While it is able to be visible negatively, some additionally view it as a reflection of cultural values surrounding community and belonging. Understanding this mentality requires a nuanced angle at the social and economic pressures faced by using individuals inside their communities.

**Filipino Time** - "Filipino time" is the cultural acceptance of time in the Philippines, which often manifests as a more lenient observance of punctuality. Sometimes it results in delays or a casual approach to scheduling, but this reflects a larger emphasis on social relationships and community rather than on time. This attitude will easily make a get-together begin later than scheduled because more attention is paid towards being in each other's presence rather than strictly to the clock. For others, this can be a very endearing part of being Filipino and "non- filipino" because it seems to emphasize connections more than time. This raises some challenges, though, especially in a more office setting where time is money.

**Utang na loob** - "Utang na loob," on the other hand, refers to the Filipino term which literally translates to "debt of gratitude." It's an obligation so strong it speaks to a feeling of something you would give your life for, an exchange between two people that should yield a strong enough feeling of respect and concern for each other. Thus, in all honesty, not only is it very important to say thank you, but actually doing good back is considered the best way to repay loans or debts of such nature. It indeed brings a feeling of interdependence through which relationships can be improved by acts of benevolence and aid. In this regard, it can foster deep relationships, while at the same time, it can perpetuate obligation or burden of return.

**Parents see children as a source of income** - For example, some Filipino parents use their children as instruments to acquire money. Often, it gets this perception from the fact that children could be of help when time comes that they can generate income for their parents. Parents would spare funds for their education just in case that their kids would be able to gain enough to sustain the family later on. This idea puts pressure on the child to perform well and improve the condition. Although at times it can develop a work ethic to excel, on the other hand, it tends to strain the parent child relationships due to overly heightened expectations.

**Hiya (Shame or Shyness)** - While being modest or respectful is valued, too much "hiya" can prevent people from speaking up or asserting themselves. This can lead to missed opportunities, unvoiced opinions, or reluctance to challenge unfair situations, which may hinder personal growth or professional advancement.

**Pakikisama (Conformity or Companionship)** - The desire to maintain harmony and avoid conflict can lead to conformity, even when someone disagrees. This can suppress individual opinions and creativity and might cause people to compromise their values or avoid addressing important issues to "keep the peace."

**Bahala Na (Fatalism or "Leave it to Fate")** - While it encourages resilience in difficult situations, "bahala na" can sometimes lead to passivity and a lack of planning. Relying too much on fate or luck may prevent people from taking responsibility for their actions or making proactive decisions to improve their circumstances.



**Short-lived Enthusiasm-** This trait refers to the tendency to be highly enthusiastic at the beginning of a project but lose interest or motivation over time. It can lead to unfinished tasks, wasted resources, and inconsistency in personal or professional commitments, which can harm long-term success.

**Self-Esteem or Pride-** While having self-respect is important, excessive pride can make it difficult for individuals to accept criticism or admit mistakes. It can lead to defensiveness, resistance to feedback, or strained relationships, as people may avoid addressing their shortcomings to protect their pride.

**Procrastination-** The "mañana habit" refers to the tendency to delay tasks or put things off for later. While it may provide temporary relief from stress, this habit often leads to poor time management, missed deadlines, and a buildup of work. It can also create unnecessary pressure and lead to lower-quality results due to rushing tasks at the last minute. This mindset hinders productivity and personal progress.

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